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A TripAdvisor® Company

 **Expedia**
Local Expert®

 **airbnb**

**Get
Your
Guide**

civitatis

KLOOK
Yours To Explore

The **LARGE** MARKETPLACE Comparison Guide

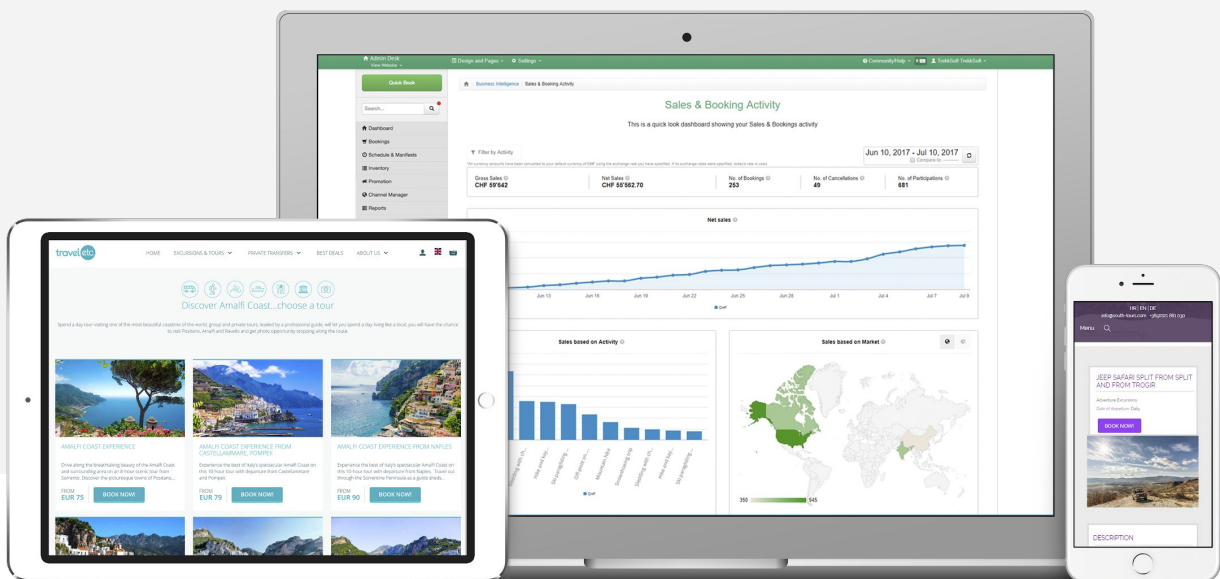
**NEW: Additional
Chapters Added**

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The #1 booking solution for tour and activity providers worldwide



Trekkssoft is trusted by thousands of tour and activity companies in 130+ countries across the globe.

Learn about the software in a demo call

Author's Note

No matter how established a tour & activity operator is, we continually hear the question:

'Are we connected with the right OTAs?'

This guide is designed to give you all the information you could need when comparing which Online Travel Agent (OTA) is right for your business and can provide you with both high quantity and top quality bookings.

In this guide, we thoroughly analyse Viator, Expedia Local Expert and GetYourGuide. We also decided to include Airbnb Experiences, Civitatis and Klook within this comparison, who, compared to the big three, are still relatively low in market share. However, each have a location specific market share and strong plans for growth in the coming years.

Enjoy!



Nicole Kow & Stephanie Kutschera

Content Marketing Team, TrekkSoft

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What is an Online Travel Agent (OTA)?

Online travel agents (OTAs) act as online marketplaces where tour and activity suppliers from all over the world can list their services. OTAs then spend a lot of time and money aggregating services from all over the world and marketing their inventory to a global customer base.

The main players in the industry at present are [Viator](#) (now renamed to TripAdvisor Experiences), [Expedia Local Expert](#) and [Get Your Guide](#). These large marketplaces have long established their presence in the travel industry and are doing a fantastic job at growing their virtual presence, and even successfully bridging the transition from online to offline, real-world customer experiences.

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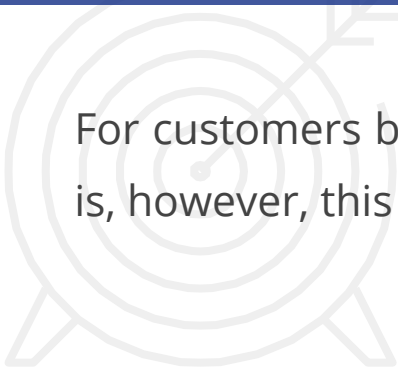
Marketplaces



Viator, founded in 2006, is now a [TripAdvisor company](#) based in San Francisco. The online marketplace is available in 11 local languages and has more than 3,500 partners worldwide to include travel providers like Hilton and Wyndham, airlines like Swiss and Etihad, loyalty programmes like American Express and Mastercard, technology partners like Tavisca and Open Jaw, and travel sites like Lonely Planet and Priceline.

In April 2018, Dermot Halpin, president of TripAdvisor Attractions and Vacation Rentals sent a memo to all employees announcing that both TripAdvisor Attractions and Viator will be branded internally and on supplier communication to [TripAdvisor Experiences](#).

“ When we communicate with both Experiences and Rentals employees, we’ll refer to this business unit as TripAdvisor Experiences and Rentals. ”



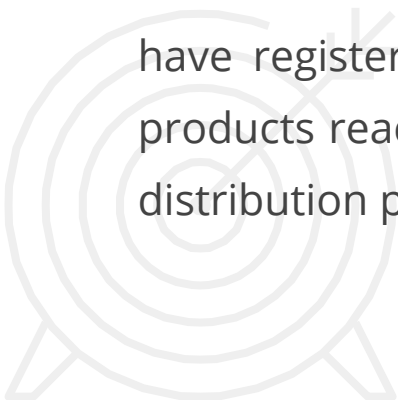
For customers booking tours and activities, for now, it will remain as is, however, this will most likely become one name in the future.

Viator (TripAdvisor Experiences)

Viator's main selling point is that it connects your TripAdvisor profile to your Viator profile, allowing site users to quickly browse and book activities, without having to leave the site.

Tour and activity operators currently can include their contact details and a direct website link on their TripAdvisor profile. This allows direct bookings whether the company is connected with Viator or not. Recent [discussions amongst suppliers](#) suggest that the company is removing the contact details section from listings and replacing with a "Book Now" button that leads directly to Viator. This appears to be at a trial stage on a selected pool of operators. Whether or not this change will become permanent, no one knows as TripAdvisor has yet to make a formal statement.

In late 2017, Viator announced that they were rolling out a new platform for [travel agents](#) to book from 104,000 trips from more than 2,400 destinations and earn an 8% commission for each booking. As of May 2018, 23,000 agents have registered to become Viator Travel Agents, and Viator products reach over 150,000 global travel agents through our distribution partners.



GetYourGuide provides over 30,000 tours and activities in over 2,500 destinations across more than 110 countries. Based in Berlin, GetYourGuide claims to find the most relevant and personalised trips for its users.

In 2015, the company secured a whopping \$50 million in funding, a sum unheard of before in the sector, to grow its operations. Then, in November 2017, the company announced that it secured another [\\$75 million in funding](#) to expand its operations internationally. GetYourGuide has now raised \$175.5 million total since its founding in 2009.

In 2017, the company also secured partnerships with airlines [EasyJet](#) and [KLM Royal Dutch Airlines](#), allowing customers to book tours and activities after booking their flights via their websites or mobile apps. Other prominent partners include Emirates, Hotels.com, hotel.info, airberlin holidays, Opodo, Thomas Cook and Lufthansa Holidays.

Tao Tao, co-founder and chief operating officer, [shared](#) that he wants the company to 'keep growing.' Tao said 'there's ample room' for all marketplaces 'to grow' in the sector because a vast majority of the activities around the world aren't bookable online yet.

GetYourGuide

In a recent interview with [Thooz](#), GetYourGuide CEO Johannes Reck said that;

‘True success in the future of travel comes down to personalization.’

The company's long-term strategy and newly secured funding will go towards making the booking experience as personalized as possible. GetYourGuide aims only to show relevant content tailored to the user.

To achieve this, they will have predictive algorithms to estimate customer value, smart recommendations based on the user's travel history, and intelligent touch points that know when a customer is more likely to be considering booking another trip.

“ So in the next five-to-ten years, you'll be seeing travel companies doing that and doing that very well and those will win and the others who don't do that will lose. ”

Expedia Local Expert was [launched back in 2014](#) and is part of Expedia Group that operates the well-known Expedia travel booking platform that offers hotels, cruises, flights, and now, "Things to do".

"Expedia Local Expert is a one-stop resource for local activities, tours, and transportation in more than 750 different vacation destinations."

Source: Expedia Website

When you sell on Expedia Local Expert, your products will be distributed online in 17 different language sites, across 57 different websites including Orbitz, AirAsia Go, Hotels.com and Ebookers. During the online booking process for accommodation or flight tickets via Expedia, "Things to do" will be displayed towards the end of the booking process, allowing customers to add tours and activities to their "Cart" seamlessly

Apart from online booking capabilities, Expedia Local Expert has a unique approach among major online competitors with offline sales. The program has in-destination kiosks staffed by '400 concierges serving guests face-to-face 365 days a year,' according to Expedia. These are located in hotels around the world, offering in-person advice to customers.

Expedia Local Expert

In February 2018, [Expedia](#) also launched "Event Tickets" to further leverage on their online booking and payment capabilities and to truly provide a one-stop shop for travellers.

[Skift reported](#) in April this year that the Expedia Group had finally shared information on how well its tours and activities business has been performing.

‘During the Q1 2018 earnings call, **CEO Mark Okerstrom** **said** the company generated “north of half-a-billion dollars in bookings” in full-year 2017 across its **Things to Do** and **Local Expert** businesses — a figure later confirmed by company spokesperson Sarah Gavin. Okerstrom also said that in the first quarter of 2018 Expedia grew its activities transactions by approximately 20 percent.’

Skift, April 2018



Despite most people thinking that Airbnb is a real estate business, the company has a current global market share of 6% in the tour and activities sector. [Airbnb Experiences](#) offer activities which are hosted by 'locals' in that city, ranging from dinners cooked by chefs to surf lessons by professionals.

'Airbnb Experiences are activities designed and led by inspiring locals. They go beyond typical tours or classes by immersing guests in each host's unique world.'

Source: Airbnb Experiences Website

Parin Mehta, APAC trips Operations Director for Airbnb described their experiences as trying to create 'something slightly different' to 'build really local and authentic experiences in every city.'

For large companies interested in listing their trips on Airbnb Experiences, a cookie cutter tour or activity will not be accepted. On the other hand, if you have the capacity to experiment with a new kind of tour, this could be the platform for you.

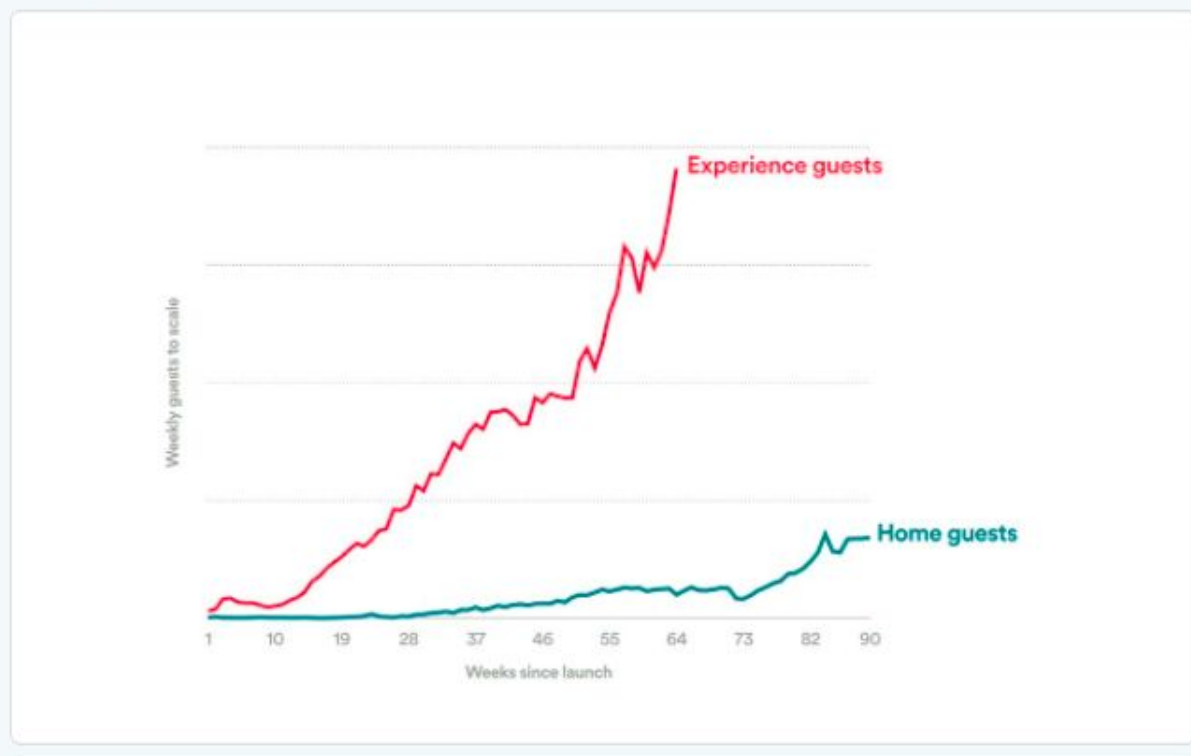
For example, you could have one your guides become the face of the Experience and offer an intimate and unique activity where their enthusiasm is shared for the destination or their interest.

Airbnb Experiences

Launched in November 2016, [Airbnb CEO, Brian Chesky](#), [recently said](#) the platform 'is now doing a million and a half bookings on an annualized basis' growing at a much faster pace than Airbnb Homes did.

Brian Chesky @bchesky · 2h

We launched Airbnb Experiences just over a year ago. Here's a graph comparing early growth of homes to experiences



Source: Airbnb Experiences Webinar, TrekkSoft, 2018

He also shared data that 'three in four millennials said they'd rather buy an experience than a physical good' showing a substantial opportunity for growth.

Airbnb Experiences

Having collaborated with Airbnb on a workshop, we've noted some key differences between Airbnb Experiences and the other marketplaces mentioned in this report.

- **A strong emphasis on the host** - Airbnb believes that Experiences are enhanced with the right type of hosts. They're not looking for companies to list their trips, but for individuals to share their interests and passions with guests.
- **Intimacy on tours** - Experiences listed on Airbnb should be catered for small groups and be exclusively offered to Airbnb's customers (i.e. no mixing with guests from other sales channels)
- **Reviews drive success** - Your Experiences will need a minimum of 10 reviews to see traction. On the other hand, Experiences that receive little to no attention within a specified time period will be removed from the platform to ensure the quality of trips offered.



Airbnb Experiences

In June 2018, [Airbnb and Utah Office of Tourism](#) announced 'a [first-of-its-kind statewide partnership](#)' to launch unique experiences hosted by Utahns. The partnership was driven by sustainable tourism and supporting the local economy.

'Last year, there were 467,300 guest arrivals to Airbnb home listings in Utah — an 87 percent increase over the previous year. With more than 50 Utah Experiences now bookable on the platform, and other potential hosts applying to list their experience every day, the economic potential for Utah residents is tremendous.'

With their regular announcements of partnerships around the world, Airbnb Experiences will undoubtedly be a platform to watch in the next few years.

A collection of travel items including a camera, a hat, and a bag.

**Insider tips to get
listed on
Airbnb Experiences**

Watch now!

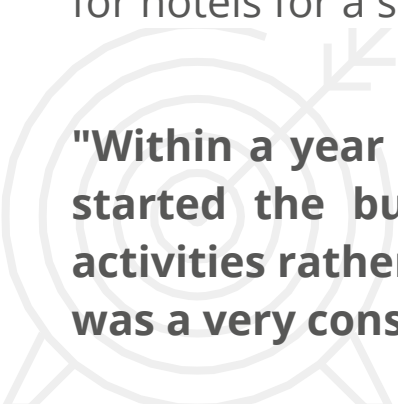
Civitatis, founded in 2009, is the leading online marketplace for destinations in the Spanish-speaking market. With almost one million customers each year, they offer 3,500 services around the world, including transfers, tours, activities and day-trips.

The company was founded by Alberto Gutiérrez, a traveler and self-confessed computer geek. In 2008, Alberto embarked on a summer adventure. Once he returned, he decided to find a way to showcase his travel experiences online.

"I like traveling a lot and wanted to make my trips more profitable, to save money, work and entertain myself, it was like a hobby." Alberto Gutiérrez

Alberto began working from home, writing tour guide publications for hotels for a small commission.

"Within a year of starting, speaking with a guide in Prague, we started the business model [for Civitatis] with the focus on activities rather than on hotel reservations because I saw that it was a very consolidated market." **Tiramillas**, 2018



Civitatis

Civitatis rapidly grew. By 2016, the company saw a 30% increase in sales and recorded an all-time high of €17 million. They were now serving more than 530,000 customers per year.

In 2017, [Civitatis refreshed their branding](#) to improve the consumer's overall shopping experience. This included a redesign of their corporate image, brand and website. Their iOS and Android apps were also given a refresh. Londres.es, Dublin.es and Paris.es are now their top location specific performing sites since the relaunch.

Civitatis is now celebrating its tenth anniversary. Within 10 years, it has guided 3 million travelers, with more than 6,400 activities in 380 destinations. In 2018, the company aims to [end the year with record figures](#) with 50 million euros in sales.

Needless to say, Civitatis is perfect for operators who provide tours in Spanish. According to the World Economic Forum, [Spanish is the second most spoken language in the world](#), just after Mandarin. If 437 million people in the world speak Spanish, as a supplier, you have 437 million potential guests.

Founded in 2014, Klook is an activity marketplace offering a range of experiences and attractions to travelers. They aim to simplify the tour & activity booking process so it will become as routine as booking a flight or hotel. Klook [‘has activities in excess of 50,000](#) and services from 5,000 partners in over 200 destinations across the world.’

Claimed to be the newest ‘Unicorn’ business, the Hong-Kong based start-up has raised nearly \$300 million in capital to date. It first closed \$30 million in March 2017, then \$60 million in October of the same year. In July 2018, Klook raised \$200 million to fund expansion in the US and Europe. According to [TechCrunch](#), a spokesperson confirmed that the current funding round values the company at more than \$1 billion.

“A lot of people thought this was a very niche sector, but it is proving to be a very valuable industry [and] we’re glad to be the leader.” Eric Gnock Fah, Co-founder and COO



Today, Klook has 16 offices with over 600 staff. It recently opened offices in London and Amsterdam, and has plans to open an office in the US before the end of 2018.

Klook

According to Skift Research [‘The State of Tours and Activities 2018’](#), although Klook only had 4% of the global market-share of sites, they were positioned as the Asian expert with 70% continent market-share.

In 2019, we should see a growth in their market share as Klook focus not only on growing users in the Asian market, China in particular, but they will also focus on bringing westerners to experience Asia.

“This [funding] round is really gearing up for global expansion. There’s still plenty of growth in Asia but now, we will be accelerating our growth into the U.S. and Europe. We’re really entering the global stage [and attracting an investor like] TCV is a testament to what we’re looking to achieve as a global player.”

Eric Gnock Fah, Co-founder and COO



In 2018, Klook is on track to gross \$1 billion in bookings. That booking milestone is “not just a representation of how Klook has grown but also a representation of this space,” [TechCrunch](#), 2018

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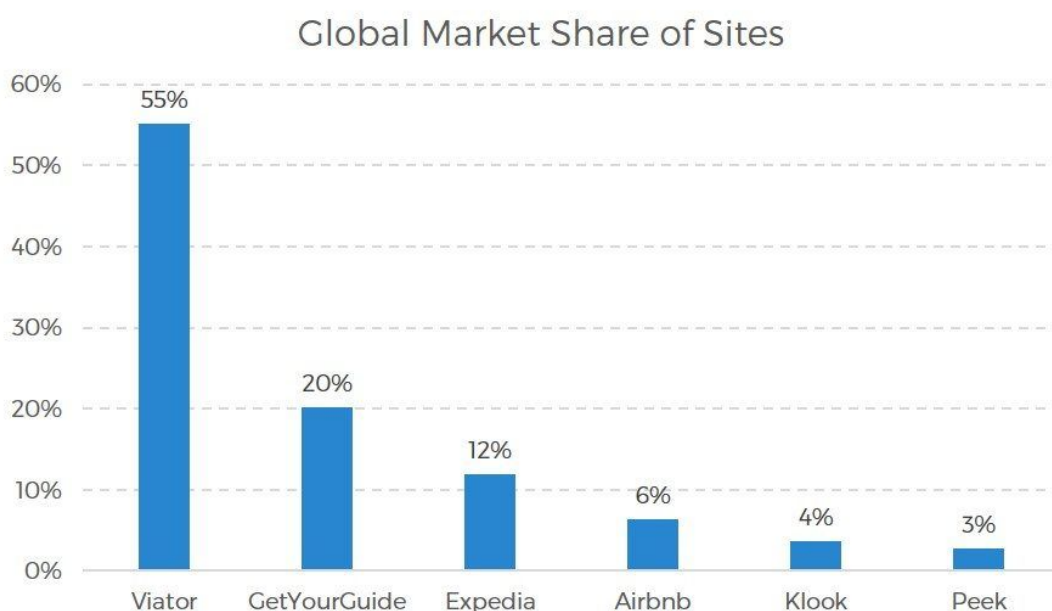
Market Share



Market Share

These marketplaces are large, huge in fact. They are established online and partner with top players in the industry, getting your products in front of a broader audience. This can be difficult for companies who want to stand out from the competition, as to get on the "Recommended" list can be tough. On the other hand, large marketplaces are susceptible to more regional competition as well as more curated, niche marketplaces.

In March 2018, Skift Research conducted an [analysis of tours and activities inventory](#) on six major online distribution platforms, Viator, Expedia, Airbnb, GetYourGuide, Klook, and Peek to get a sense of regional listings and approximate current market shares.



Source: Skift Research, Company Websites

Market Share

When it comes to tours and activities, [Skift reports that](#) Viator currently holds the highest number of tour and activity listings globally (55%), followed by GetYourGuide (20%) and Expedia Local Expert (12%).

The comparatively low number of listings on Expedia at the moment could be a window of opportunity for operators who want to establish their presence on the marketplace as there's significantly less competition at the moment. By next year we may see a substantial increase from Airbnb (6%) and Klook (4%).

Percent of Inventory in a Given Geography					
Region	Viator	Expedia	GetYourGuide	Airbnb	Klook
Europe	37%	34%	57%	44%	14%
Asia	30%	26%	15%	24%	70%
U.S. and Canada	11%	21%	9%	20%	7%
Africa and Middle East	12%	6%	11%	1%	4%
South and Central America	7%	7%	5%	6%	0%
Oceania	3%	5%	3%	5%	5%

Source: [Skift Research, Company Websites](#)

Skift also reports that Europe (37%), Asia (30%) and Africa & Middle East (12%) are the top three regions where Viator's inventory comes from. For Expedia, a majority of inventory comes from Europe (34%), Asia (26%) and US & Canada (21%).

Market Share

GetYourGuide has the largest market in Europe (57%), followed by Asia (15%), Africa & Middle East (11%) and US & Canada (9%). Airbnb Experiences have the second largest market in Europe (44%), and a good presence in Asia (24%) and US & Canada (20%). Klook is the largest marketplace in Asia (70%), followed by Europe (14%) and US & Canada (7%). This is expected to grow in 2019.

As they were not included in the Skift Research, we are unable to see an inventory comparison for Civitatis. We spoke with a representative from Civitatis who confirmed that although they lead the Spanish speaking market, they do not have any market percentage information at this point. We would expect that Civitatis cover a large market share of Latin America and Europe.

Skift also collected data on nearly 70,000 activities. The result was that Viator had the highest number of listings for the cities tracked. This data corroborates with Skift's previous reports that Viator/TripAdvisor is in the lead when it comes to online attractions. The report noted that 'it has the largest number of tour listings, more than twice as many as its next closest competitor. We estimate that Viator has nearly 55 percent market share worldwide.'

TOURISM TRENDS

LATIN AMERICA TREND REPORT 2018

For tour & activity operators

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3

Website Traffic



Why is website traffic important when choosing an OTA?

Website traffic is an important factor when selecting which platforms you wish to work with. The number of visitors equals the number of opportunities you have to attract new customers. The percentage of users by location should be best matched with your target market, tourism to your location, flight/travel connections and visa requirements.



Website Traffic

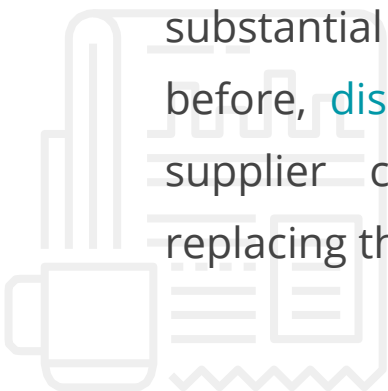
Viator

Viator's site brings in close to 9 million visitors a month, with 38.7% of traffic coming from the United States, 6.6% from the UK, 4.5% from Canada and 4% from Australia and 4%. The site ranks globally at 5921, and 2721 in the United States.

However, if you were to analyse Viator's performance without taking into account TripAdvisor's performance, that would be a mistake. With more than 20% of Viator's traffic coming from TripAdvisor the review site plays a significant role in Viator's success.

TripAdvisor receives 164 million visits a month, with TripAdvisor.com attracting 58% of visits from the US and TripAdvisor.co.uk attracting 87% of traffic from the UK. TripAdvisor.com ranks 182 globally, 62 in the US, and 1st in the tourism category.

While they have yet to figure out a way to channel a more substantial proportion of this traffic to Viator, as mentioned before, [discussion](#) suggests that the company is removing supplier contact details from TripAdvisor listings and replacing them with "Book Now" buttons that lead to Viator.



Website Traffic

Expedia Local Expert

Expedia attracts almost 60 million visitors a month, with 79% of traffic coming from the United States, 1.17% from Canada, 0.91% from Israel, 0.80% from Mexico and only 0.79% from the UK.

Globally, the website ranks at 609 as of today and ranks 137 in the US. It also ranks number 4 in the tourism category.

While Expedia Local Expert, the tour and activities section of the website still lags behind, in time the site will see tremendous growth as they continue to direct traffic from Expedia to Local Expert.

GetYourGuide

GetYourGuide, on the other hand, has an audience of 4.3 million visitors a month, with mixed sources of traffic: 17.9% from the US, 9.75% from the UK, 4.49% from Germany, 3.53% from Australia and 3.5% from Spain. With a volume of traffic, the site also ranks lower across the board, with a global ranking of 15,559, US rank of 13,924 and 112 in the tourism category.



Website Traffic

Do note with these figures that GetYourGuide is its own platform exclusively for attractions. Viator, however, is driven by TripAdvisor traffic, and Expedia has a much more varied offering with hotels, flights and car rentals. Both websites will always reach a higher volume of traffic, but not all visitors will be your target audience.

Airbnb Experiences

Airbnb.com attracts more than 75 million website visitors a month and ranks 2nd in the accommodation and hotels category. Traffic comes predominantly from the United States (59%). However, Airbnb has location-specific websites for the UK, France, Germany, Italy, Canada and Russia which generate an average of 12 million visitors per site.

Civitatis

Civitatis.com has around 1.44 million website visitors per month, with 65.5% coming from Spain, 9.16% from Argentina, 3.26% from Mexico and 1.97% from Chile. Civitatis use a range of location specific domains and website subdomains to attract travelers so their reach will be much larger.

In 2017, Civitas completed a full redesign of their website which has increased traffic from Europe.

Website Traffic

Klook

Klook.com is ranked 120 in the tourism category. The website attracts around 4.93 million visitors each month predominantly from the Asian market. 36.16% of users are located in Taiwan, 12.42% in Hong Kong, 8.78% Vietnam and 6.86% Singapore. 4.59% of users are located in the United States.

We will expect to see an increase in the United States and European countries in 2019.

Find updated web traffic stats on [Viator here](#), [GetYourGuide here](#), [Expedia here](#), [Airbnb here](#), [Civitatis here](#) and [Klook here](#).



4

Commission Rates



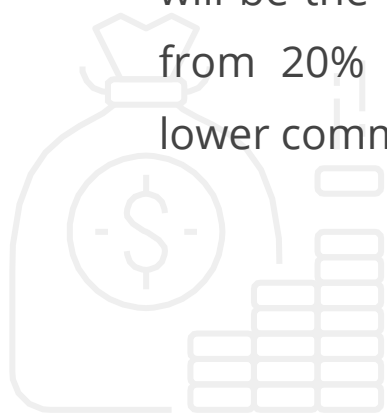
Commission Rates

For most marketplaces, you only pay a commission when a booking is made.

Viator, Expedia and Civitatis work on a case by case basis, and you'll need to speak to your Account Manager (Viator & Civitatis) or Destination Manager (Expedia) to negotiate a commission rate that works for both your businesses. As an extra clause, Viator requires all prices listed to be the lowest available price, meaning that you're not allowed to sell your trips for a lower price on your website.

Read: How much should you pay for distribution?

GetYourGuide isn't as clear-cut and sets a commission rate based on the supplier's destination and type of activities offered. The commission rate includes all booking costs, from credit card fees to bank transactions and promotion of your trips through its distribution partners. Your account manager will be the one setting the commission rate, which can range from 20% to 30%, with higher volume suppliers receiving lower commission rates.



Commission Rates

As for Airbnb Experiences, it's a straightforward 20% on each trip.

Klook follows a commission model of between 15 and 25% on activities booked.

The only additional cost you might incur with commission rates are your bank transfer fees, which you can easily add to your retail price of the tour.

Are commissions worth it?

When working with online marketplaces, your marketing cost is replaced by your commission rates, which can work out to be more cost-effective depending on your marketing strategy and the deal you strike with your account manager. Think about it, the chances of you attracting the same volume of traffic as these marketplaces do is slim at best. It takes time, energy and expertise, something that these online marketplaces have perfected over the years.

Furthermore, at the end of each tour, your customers will receive an automated email from the marketplace asking for a review. If you're interested in building your reputation on either one of these platforms, this could be a good thing for you too.

AN EASY GUIDE TO IMPROVE — YOUR — CONVERSION RATES



This guide is jam-packed with easy to implement tips and tricks to optimise your website for conversions.

Get your copy today!

5

Policies



Policies

Cancellation policies

The cancellation policies guaranteed by OTAs can put operators in a tight spot. With Viator and GetYourGuide, customers can cancel up to 24 hours before the scheduled departure time to receive a full refund.

We've spoken to Viator's PR team, and they've confirmed that there's no way for suppliers to choose another option. This can be tricky for operators to anticipate demand and sales they can make in a month. The policy will differ for multi-day tours.

With Expedia, you can determine your cancellation policy and refunds will be made accordingly. Those booking an Airbnb Experiences are permitted to cancel within 24 hours of booking or 30 days or more before the experience start date and get a full refund.

With Klook and Civitatis, the cancellation period is stated at the time of purchase, and varies depending on the activity and operator preference.



Policies

Insurance policies

Viator, GetYourGuide, Expedia, Civitatis and Klook stress that all suppliers need to provide insurance coverage to customers and requires suppliers to provide a Public Liability Certificate of Insurance (or COI).

Airbnb Experiences provide their own [experience protection insurance](#) which covers some aspect of the tour, but it would be advised to check that you are fully covered in all circumstances.

Learn more about each OTA cancellation and insurance policy by visiting [Viator's FAQ page](#), [GetYourGuide FAQ page](#), [Expedia's FAQ page](#), [Civitatis FAQ Page](#), [Klook FAQ Page](#) and [Airbnb Experiences Cancellation Page](#).



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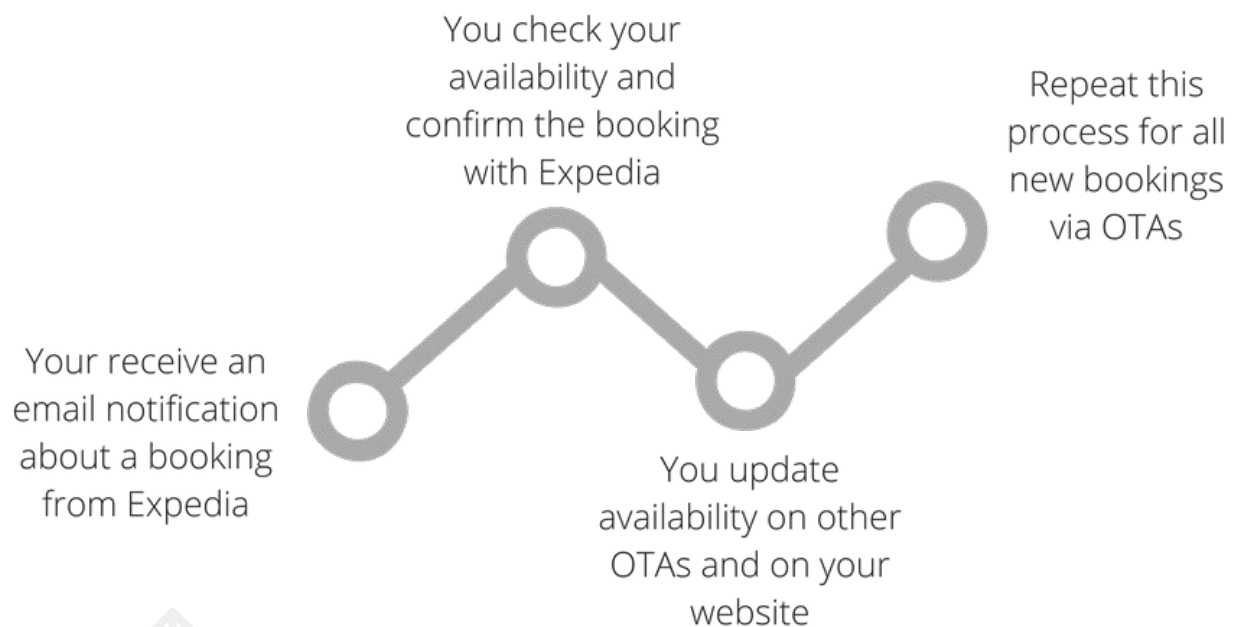
Getting Connected



API Connections

When working with multiple distribution channels, it's always a good idea to consider using a booking system that offers real-time availabilities via API connections. This feature is called a Channel Manager and essentially takes out the manual work required to update your inventory with the latest availabilities, prices and schedules.

The booking process without a Channel Manager



A Channel Manager is a feature offered by many booking systems on the market, including TrekkSoft. It's a term widely used in property management systems for hoteliers, but the term has yet to catch on in the tour and activity sector.

API Connections

For TrekkSoft customers, the entire reselling and management process is simplified by enabling backend connections between TrekkSoft and the OTA of your choice. Our Channel Manager allows you to adjust the capacities of your trips easily, adjust prices, and seamlessly upload pictures and descriptions of your tours.

The booking process with TrekkSoft Channel Manager



On top of that, every time a customer books from the OTA, TrekkSoft will automatically update the number of available spaces for that trip across all your sales channels.

Currently, TrekkSoft's Channel Manager allows you to connect to Viator, Expedia, Get Your Guide, Civitatis, Musement, Hotelbeds, Tigtets, Veltra, TourRadar and more. We aim to offer connection to Klook early 2019



Grow your reach with Online Travel Marketplaces

Watch this webinar to learn what online travel marketplaces are and what benefits you can see if connecting to one.

[Watch now!](#)

Sign Up

It's free to sign up for all of these marketplaces. Like we mentioned earlier, you only pay a commission when a booking is made.

Viator

To sign up for Viator, visit their [Supplier Sign-up page](#). You will receive an application form and agreement. When a supplier accepts the agreement, you'll receive a login ID and a password for Viator's extranet. This is the home account for the suppliers. They can add, edit products, see bookings, manage customers and do a lot more through this platform.

Expedia

To sign up with Expedia, head over to their [FAQ and sign-up page](#). Here suppliers register by filling out a form asking for their contact details. Your profile will be reviewed, and if approved, you will be contacted by an Expedia team member to begin your onboarding process.

GetYourGuide

To sign up with GetYourGuide, head over to their [Supplier Administration page](#). Here suppliers register by filling out a form asking for their contact details.

Sign Up

You'll then get an email to complete the registration and agree to the terms and conditions of the company. After this, your account is ready for use.

Airbnb Experiences

You can head over to the Airbnb Experiences [supplier sign up page](#) where you will need to fill out a form with as much detail as you can about the “host” and the experience you wish to share with travellers. It will take them 3 working days to review and respond to your application.

Civitatis

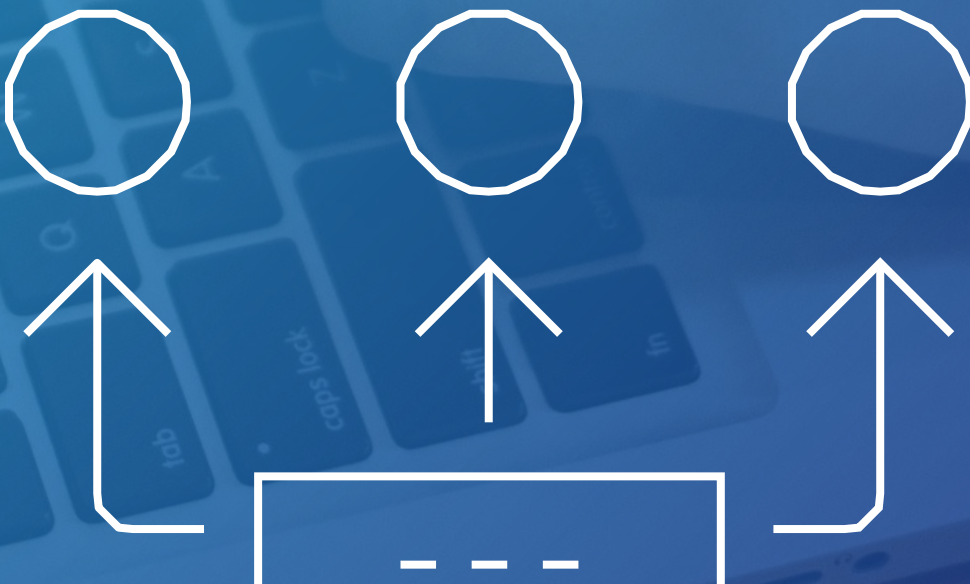
To sign up with Civitatis, you need to submit a [registration request](#). Once completed, your application will be evaluated by the Civitatis team who base approval on strict internal guidelines that check the popularity, quality and price of each activity and day trip.

Klook

To reach the FIT travel market in Asia, you can register with Klook on their [partner page](#). You should include as much information as possible about your tours, booking volume and expectations of bookings with Klook.

7

Distribution Strategy



OTAs as *one part* of your distribution strategy

In 2016, we conducted a survey with suppliers using TrekkSoft and found that on average, suppliers worked with at least three OTAs at any one time. In addition, they also worked with incoming tour operators, local point of sale and maintained a steady flow of bookings from their own websites.

Here are some tips to create a balanced distribution strategy to ensure a steady stream of bookings:

1. Never depend on just one source for bookings

Your business needs multiple sources of bookings to thrive and remain sustainable. Create a balanced distribution network with several strong booking sources to avoid the pressure if external factors suddenly work against your favour (which, in tourism, they often will).

2. Never depend on just one market for bookings

No matter how secure one market might seem, you should never rely on it alone. Things can all too easily change, so make sure your business is open to multiple markets.

3. Maintain a healthy spread of high and zero commission rates

[From our research](#), a majority of providers were reluctant to pay over 15% commission. While it can be difficult to avoid commission entirely – especially if you want to benefit from OTAs and resellers – you can ease the strain by maintaining a healthy spread of high and zero commission rates.

4. Build partnerships, no matter the size of your business

Cross-sell with local partners and promote each others' services online to boost your exposure and increase bookings. You can use a tool like TrekkSoft's Partner Network to cross-sell without having to pick up the phone or send an email.

Industry Research

The tours and activities distribution landscape of today.

Get the full report here >>



Final Words

We've reached the end! We hope that you now have all the information needed to select the right OTA for your business.

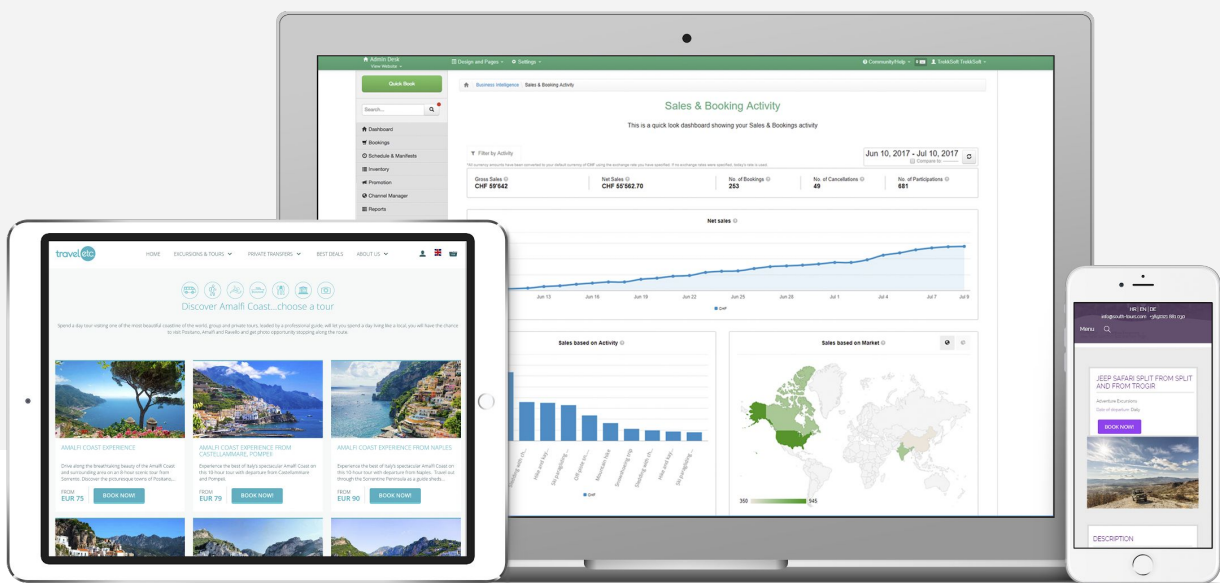
If there is a crucial takeaway you should implement immediately, it's to review your target market and decide which OTA is best suited to help you grow. Remember that quality is better than quantity when it comes to how many OTAs you should connect with.

To enhance your booking process, reduce administration time and eliminate any human errors, a channel manager is necessary. At TrekkSoft we have API connections in place for the large OTAs, plus many more marketplaces across the world.

We wish you every success!



The #1 booking solution for tour and activity operators worldwide



Connect with 15 different marketplaces and business partners worldwide with TrekkSoft's unique API integrations.

Learn about our Channel Manager in a demo call